

Design Decisions

Key UX choices made for the Home screen redesign — with rationale and principles.

APP HEADER

01 Accessibility

44pt minimum touch targets

Header icons are wrapped in 44×44pt transparent tap targets per Apple HIG. The visual icon stays unchanged; only the interaction area grows. Reduces tap errors, especially for one handed use in the morning.

Apple HIG · WCAG 2.1 AAA · Fitts's Law

MORNING BANNER

02 Visual Hierarchy

Three tier morning narrative

The banner layers information in three tiers: (1) a context row with a Body Battery icon and a readiness chip for quick orientation; (2) an activity headline paired with a one-line recommendation that translates metrics into action, replacing the redundant sleep output already visible in the Sleep Score card below; (3) a compact metric strip showing Sleep duration, Body Battery, HRV and Stress at a glance. The layout follows natural F-pattern scanning, leading with the most important information first.

F pattern scanning · Progressive disclosure · Redundancy reduction

03 UX Writing

Coaching voice over raw data

Metrics are translated into a direct recommendation ('You're ready to train') instead of leaving interpretation to the user. This bridges data to action and makes the morning check-in feel like a coach, not a dashboard.

Coaching voice · Insight-to-action bridge

SLEEP SCORE

04 Information Architecture

Insight first, number second

The screen opens with a natural-language verdict ('You slept well') before showing 79/100. The narrative sets the frame so the score becomes confirmation rather than the primary cognitive load.

Progressive disclosure · Narrative UX

05 Data Visualisation

Sleep stage colour language

Each sleep stage uses a colour that reflects its function: Deep is purple to anchor physical recovery; REM is orange to signal its cognitively active, dream state character; Light uses a softer tint for its transitional role; and Awake segments use coral as a minor alert. Replacing Garmin's original monochrome bar with this semantic palette lets users read a night's composition in seconds without a legend. The score badge colour (green, amber, red) then sits on top as a single glance verdict.

Sleep science semantics · Colour encoding · Preattentive attributes

AT A GLANCE

06 Data Visualisation

Ring gauges replace flat numbers

At a Glance widgets use a circular arc gauge. The arc fill communicates range proximity before the user reads the value, matching Garmin Connect's native visual language and enabling faster scanning.

Preattentive attributes · Garmin design language

07 UX Pattern

Wellness metric grid

At a Glance groups metrics into a customisable ring gauge grid. Readiness metrics and performance metrics sit together, preventing users from acting on any single metric in isolation.

Readiness signal · Gestalt grouping · Performance context

LAST ACTIVITY

08 Motivation

Delta annotations vs personal baseline

Activity rows show performance deltas against the user's personal baseline rather than absolute values. Relative progress is more motivating, as context makes numbers meaningful.

Relative progress · Personal baseline

CONSISTENCY BAR

09 NEW Habit Formation

Consistency Bar

Inspired by Seinfeld's 'don't break the chain' method, applied in Nathan Barry's Commit app. Each health pillar (Sleep, Activity, Stress and Steps) gets its own 14 day bar chain, each filled in its signature colour: blue for Sleep, green for Activity, purple for Stress and orange for Steps. This lets users spot the exact pillar and day they missed, without relying on a single aggregate score. The hero number counts consecutive days all four pillars were on track.

Seinfeld Chain · Nathan Barry's Commit · Per-pillar accountability

Chain mechanic

14 day bars per pillar; height encodes quality: stub = miss, medium = partial, tall = on track

Hero metric

Counts only days when all 4 pillars are on track simultaneously, the true consistency signal

Per-pillar streaks

Each pillar shows its own streak badge to pinpoint the weakest link (e.g. Sleep 9d · Stress 6d)

CTA

'Don't break the chain' with today's log prompt, action oriented rather than data passive

INTERACTION DESIGN

10 Consistency

Uniform affordance language

All section actions use the same arrow-link pattern: Customize →, See details →, All Activities →, Full history →. One interaction pattern throughout eliminates learning overhead and makes every section scannable in the same way.

Nielsen's consistency heuristic · Platform conventions

11 Visual Design

Consistent rating colour scale

All quality ratings follow the same colour progression: yellow (#FFD60A) for Fair, lime (#A3E635) for Good and green (#30D158) for Excellent. This scale is applied consistently across the Sleep Score Scale and the Training Readiness chip states, so the same colour always signals the same level regardless of context. Users do not need to re-learn the scale when switching between sleep and training data.

Nielsen consistency heuristic · Colour semantics · Cross-screen coherence

SLEEP DETAILS

12 Data Visualisation

Height encoding for stage legibility

The original chain used bars at similar heights, making it hard to scan and differentiate sleep stages at a glance. The Awake stage in particular blended in with the others despite being fundamentally different. Switching to height encoding, Deep at full chain height (120px), REM at 95px, Light at 42px and Awake collapsed to 12px, makes each stage instantly recognisable by its visual footprint. Awake segments now read as brief interruptions rather than equivalent sleep phases, and the overall architecture of the night becomes legible without consulting the legend.

Preattentive attributes · Height encoding · Scannable data visualisation

13 Data Visualisation

Perceptually distinct stage colours

User feedback revealed that the original sleep chain was difficult to read because multiple stages shared similar pink and reddish tones, making them nearly indistinguishable at a glance, particularly REM and Awake when the bars were thin. The redesign replaces those ambiguous tones with four hues that sit far apart on the colour wheel: purple for Deep (#7b5cee), orange for REM (#FF9500), blue for Light (#5ba4e8) and coral for Awake (#ed7874). Each stage now carries an unambiguous visual identity that holds up at small sizes and in low-light conditions, removing the need to cross-reference the legend to identify what you are looking at.

User feedback · Perceptual colour distance · WCAG contrast

14 Interaction Design

Chain selectors replaced by a slide

The original Sleep Details screen displayed a horizontal chain of metric selectors at the bottom (Awake, Restlessness, Resting Heart Rate, Body Battery and others). To switch context, users had to swipe along the selectors to find the desired option and then tap it individually, a two-step interaction. This was replaced by a segmented slide control that surfaces all available options at once, communicates the active state through a white pill background and requires a single tap to switch. The pattern is native to iOS, immediately familiar and cuts the interaction cost in half.

iOS HIG segmented control · Progressive disclosure · Navigation overhead reduction

WHILE YOU SLEPT

15 Visual Design

Semantic icon colour system

Each metric icon is colour coded by body system rather than by status. Teal (#00BCD4) for sleep, coral (#ed7874) for heart and HRV metrics, blue (#5595ec) for respiratory metrics, orange (#FF9500) for energy and battery, lime (#A3E635) for activity, and purple (#7b5cee) for stress. This lets users scan the grid and instantly identify which system a number belongs to without reading every label, leveraging pre-attentive processing to reduce cognitive load.

Semantic colour coding · iOS Health colour system · Pre-attentive processing